

5.9 Anti-phishing Tools

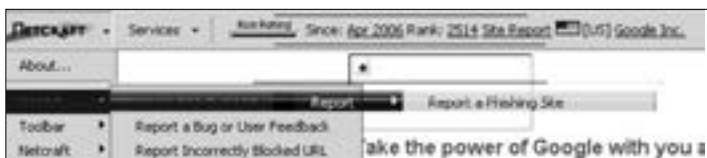
5.9.1 Introduction

Since versions Opera 8, Firefox 2, and IE7, all three browsers have included controls to identify if a certain Web site is “phishy.” All anti-phishing tools work in a similar fashion: any URL the user visits is passed to a central Web site that maintains a list of sites that have been reported to be phishy. If the URL is indeed phishy, the browser indicates this.

To augment the prowess of the browser, additional controls can be installed. These are usually in the form of plugins or add-ons that show up as browser toolbars or buttons.

5.9.2 Netcraft Toolbar

This is available for Firefox and IE. In Firefox, this is installed as a toolbar that displays information about Web sites. By using the Report option under the Netcraft menu, a user can report a suspicious site to Netcraft for further analysis. A wrongly-identified site can also be reported.



The Netcraft toolbar on Firefox

When the user tries to visit a site that has been identified as a phishing site, an alert is displayed. The user still has the option to visit the site. A similar function is available while using the EarthLink toolbar (www.earthlink.Net/software/free/toolbar/) and Google toolbar. But both these offer a lot more than what was asked for, and are larger in size. For someone looking for just an anti-phishing tool, the Netcraft toolbar is adequate. Opera users will need the Google toolbar, since the rest do not support Opera.



A sample Netcraft phishing alert